

2nd Feb 2026 | DAG101

→ Backpropagation in MLPs

- SL → Data → $D = \{(x_i, y_i)\}$ features → target
 Model → funcⁿ that maps input x to y .
 ↳ fixed HPTs (no. of layers, no. of neurons)

Parameters → wts. & b, have to be learned

Obj. / Loss funcⁿ → $J(w)$, diff. b/w $\hat{y}$ & y .
 Learning algo → optimizaⁿ technique to reduce loss funcⁿ.

- Regression → predict conti. quantity.

Classificaⁿ → predict class probabilities (1 of k classes)
 ↳ 2 → binary classificaⁿ
 ↳ 'discriminative' models $P(Y|x)$

- Linear actuaⁿ → $a(z) = z$ per-actuaⁿ

- Loss funcⁿ

Regres.

↳ MSE → $L = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N (y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2$
 penalize larger errors heavily

↳ MAE → $L = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N |y_i - \hat{y}_i|$
 robust to outliers

- Classificaⁿ → this one sum up to 1.

which of this output, prob. add up to 1.

① Multi Class → mutually exclusive (1-hot)
 ↳ actuaⁿ → softmax $\sigma(z) = \frac{e^{x_i}}{\sum_j e^{x_j}}$

② Multi Label → independent / non-exclusive
 ↳ 'sigmoid' $\sigma(z) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-z}}$ → sigmoid for every output

- these actuaⁿs work as the output layer

- Multi Class

Loss $\rightarrow$ Categorical cross-entropy

total no. of classes $\leftarrow$

$$L = - \sum_{c=1}^C y_c \log(\hat{y}_c)$$

$y_c = 1$ for true class

Multi label

Loss $\rightarrow$ binary cross-entropy (BCE)

total no. of classes $\leftarrow$

$$L = \frac{1}{M} \sum_{j=1}^M [y_j \log(\hat{y}_j) + (1 - y_j) \log(1 - \hat{y}_j)]$$

$\rightarrow$ Summed over all output nodes

BCE $\rightarrow$ penalizes larger errors heavily, wrong predictions on both sides.